



makes them sound a bit demure. The cabin insulation does aid the overall audio performance, with very good cabin insulation blocking out most of the road noise.

The MID on the instrument cluster mirrors the infotainment system, in a similar fashion as we've seen in all Volkswagen and Skoda cars so far. It is really easy to operate via steering-mounted controls, and offers almost every feature you'd need to access on road. The Passat also gets white ambient lighting with footwell illumination (only one colour), three-zone climate

control, an electronic multi-step sunroof, and 'easy boot' with handsfree opening. The front seats get a host of options, with the driver seat getting multi-way electronic adjustment with adjustable lumbar support, multiple massage options and seat heating as well. The heated seats may not be the most usable feature in India, but adds to the comfort features nonetheless.

Furthermore, the Passat gets a 360-degree surround camera with ParkTronic sensors, which is unique in this segment. It also provides handsfree parking, with auto-identification of parallel and perpendicular parking spots. Manually-controllable suspension height adjustment, auto headlamps and wipers, and active cornering lamps wrap up the total list of features that the Passat offers, and the overall set is presented in a smooth, understated cabin, highlighted by the fact that apart from a navigation module and upgradable speaker options, you pretty much get everything you'd need in a car. There's ample storage, and the main glove box is cooled and illuminated as well.

The cabin gets touches of chrome on the linings and dials, with a single veneer strip running along the cabin. The very well-bolstered seats are clad in Nappa leather upholstery, and the seats themselves offer excellent support and are really comfortable in long journeys. Thigh support is quite impressive, and the rear seat offers good pitch for three people to be seated comfortably. The only issue is the central column that protrudes from the front, making it slightly difficult for the mid-

dle seat passenger to be completely at ease. The middle passenger does get a headrest, though, and the seat bolstering is not entirely uncomfortable.

The Passat is powered by the 2-litre, 4-cylinder turbocharged diesel engine that produces 177bhp and 350Nm torque. This is paired with the equally trusted 7-speed DSG gearbox, along with McPherson strut front suspension with anti-roll bar and rear multi-link axle. VW has also included its electronic variable power assist module to the steering wheel, and the Passat plies on 17-inch alloys with a 66-litre fuel tank. Hit the road, and it almost feels like the Passat puts a balm over the corroded roads, the cacophony of noises around you and a hundred other aberrations. The in-cabin insulation is simply supreme, and the stupendous suspension balance veers towards the softer side to make the Passat an incredibly comfortable car to drive around the city in. The engine is responsive, but has a steady, laidback character. It has enough punch to charge forward, but even at that, there is a calmness in the way the Passat picks up speed.

The Passat is over 4.7 metres long and weighs 1.5 tons. However, you do not feel that the car is too heavy, at any point. There is a nice heft to the chassis, which contributes to the lower centre of gravity, and in turn makes the Passat a great handling car. The Volkswagen Passat is built to let you travel in comfort, be it in the driver's seat or in the rear. In the back seat, you can plonk in a cup of coffee in the central cup holder, pull up the sun blinds, set the temperature and air flow to what you please and spread your legs out to simply relax. In the front, you can cruise along happily, with such a large sedan happily posting fuel economy figures of over 14kmpl on the highway.

The Volkswagen Passat is all about the timeless spirit of effortless comfort, and that is where the few missing elements in the technology package do not bog you down. You are going to enjoy this one, no matter what. **4**

Read the full review here:

<https://digit.in/VW-Passat-revieww>

